



ULTIMATE TRAVEL CAMERA CHECKLIST

Everything You Need to Pack, Prepare, and Protect Your Gear

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"I traveled across three continents and filmed over 50 cameras on real holidays. Here's what I learned about what to pack — and what to leave behind."

1. Introduction — Why This Checklist Exists

You've done your research. You've chosen the perfect camera for your trip. You've read every review and watched every video. Now comes the hard part: Actually packing your gear without forgetting something critical.

I've been there. I've forgotten chargers in hotels. I've run out of storage on day two of a two-week trip. I've had batteries die in the middle of a once-in-a-lifetime sunset. This checklist exists to make sure you never make those mistakes again.

How to Use This Guide:

- Print this checklist (or save it on your phone)
- Go through each section 3-5 days before your trip
- Check off items as you pack them
- Use the 24-hour checklist the night before you leave

2. Pre-Trip Preparation

Clean Your Gear

- ☐ **Sensor Cleaning:** Use a sensor cleaning kit or professional service
- ☐ **Lens Cleaning:** Microfiber cloths and lens cleaning solution
- ☐ **Body Cleaning:** Wipe down camera body (remove dust, dirt, fingerprints)
- ☐ **Contacts & Ports:** Clean battery contacts and memory card ports

Pro Tip: Clean your gear 48 hours before departure, not the night before. You'll notice things you missed.

Update Firmware & Software

- ☐ **Camera Firmware:** Check manufacturer website for latest version
- ☐ **Lens Firmware:** Especially important for mirrorless cameras
- ☐ **Editing Apps:** Update Lightroom, CapCut, or whatever you use
- ☐ **Cloud Backup:** Ensure auto-backup is enabled for your phone

Test Everything

- ☐ **Charge All Batteries:** Fully charge each battery once
- ☐ **Test All Memory Cards:** Format them in the camera you'll use
- ☐ **Test Lenses:** Ensure autofocus, image stabilization, and zoom work
- ☐ **Test Microphones:** Verify audio quality
- ☐ **Test Tripods & Mounts:** Tighten any loose parts
- ☐ **Test Wireless Connection:** Phone-to-camera Bluetooth/WiFi

3. Camera & Lens Checklist

Primary & Backup Gear

- ☐ **Camera Body:** The one you plan to use most
- ☐ **Backup Camera:** Second body or reliable smartphone
- ☐ **Lens (Primary):** Your go-to lens for most shots
- ☐ **Lens (Secondary):** Specialty lens (portrait, wide, zoom)

Setup Option	Recommended Gear
The "One Camera" Option	DJI Osmo Pocket 3/4, Canon G7 X Mark IV, Sony ZV-1 II, or Smartphone (iPhone 17 Pro Max / Samsung Galaxy S25 Ultra)
The "Two Camera" Option	Primary: Mirrorless/compact camera Backup: Action camera (GoPro / DJI Action) or smartphone

Lens Checklist (Interchangeable Lenses)

- ☐ **Standard Zoom:** 24-70mm or 24-105mm (best all-round)
- ☐ **Wide Angle:** 16-35mm or 14-24mm (landscapes, architecture)
- ☐ **Prime Lens:** 35mm or 50mm (low-light, portraits, bokeh)
- ☐ **Telephoto Zoom:** 70-200mm or 70-300mm (wildlife, distant subjects)

Pro Tip: "Pack for the trip, not for the gear." Ask yourself: "Will I actually use this lens every day?" If no, leave it home.

4. Accessories Checklist

Stabilization & Support

Item	Pack?	Notes
Gimbal	☐	For smooth handheld video (Osmo Pocket, DJI RS, Hohem)
Tripod	☐	Full-size for landscapes / low-light
Mini Tripod	☐	Travel-sized (Joby GorillaPod, Ulanzi)
Action Mounts	☐	Chest, helmet, bike, or suction mount

Filters & Audio

- ☐ **CPL (Polarizing) Filter:** Reduce glare, boost colors (water, glass, foliage)
- ☐ **Variable ND Filter:** Adjustable light reduction for video in bright daylight
- ☐ **On-Camera / Wireless Mic:** Directional mic or wireless setup (DJI Mic 2, Rode Wireless GO II)
- ☐ **Deadcat / Windshield:** Essential for reducing outdoor wind noise

5. Power, Storage & Protection

Batteries & Charging

- ☐ **Camera Batteries:** 2-3 spares (OEM or high quality)
- ☐ **Power Bank:** 20,000mAh+ with fast charging capability
- ☐ **Chargers & Adapters:** Dual-bay charger, USB-C wall adapter, and car charger

Memory Cards & Storage Planning

- ☐ **Main Cards:** 3-4 high speed 128GB+ SD cards (UHS-II recommended)
- ☐ **Backup Cards:** 2-3 extra cards (never delete footage until safely backed up)
- ☐ **Portable SSD:** Samsung T7 or similar for nightly laptop/phone backups

Travel Duration	Recommended Storage
Day Trip (1 day)	128GB or more
Weekend Getaway (2-3 days)	256GB+
One-Week Trip	512GB+
Multi-Week Trip	1TB+ (spread across multiple cards)

Protection Essentials

- ☐ **Main Camera Bag:** Padded backpack or messenger-style bag
- ☐ **Waterproof Rain Cover:** Protects bag and gear from sudden downpours
- ☐ **Travel Insurance:** Covers theft, loss, and accidental damage
- ☐ **Gear Inventory:** List of all gear with serial numbers and photos

Pro Tip: Always pack your camera gear in your carry-on luggage. Never check valuable camera equipment.

6. Destination-Specific Add-Ons

- 🏖️ **Beach / Water:** Waterproof housing, float strap, dry bag, extra microfiber cloths for sand defense.
- ❄️ **Ski / Cold Weather:** Camera cold cover, extra batteries (keep in inside warm pockets), anti-fog inserts.
- 🏜️ **Desert / Dusty:** Rocket air blower, lens pen, sealed dust-resistant camera bag, sun hood.
- 🏙️ **City / Urban:** Discreet camera body, secure strap, mini tripod for tight crowds, lens hood for bumping protection.

7. Final 24-Hour Checklist

- ☐ Charge all batteries (camera, gimbal, action cam, phone, power banks)
- ☐ Format all memory cards in-camera
- ☐ Clean all lenses with microfiber cloth
- ☐ Pack all gear securely in your camera bag
- ☐ Download offline maps and save sunrise/sunset times to your phone
- ☐ Take a quick "test photo" to ensure everything is operating smoothly

8. Bonus: Camera Settings Cheat Sheet

Scenario	Aperture	Shutter Speed	ISO
Daylight / Sun	f/5.6 – f/11	1/100 – 1/1000	100 - 400
Golden Hour	f/2.8 – f/5.6	1/60 – 1/250	400 - 800
Night / Low Light	f/1.8 – f/2.8	1/30 – 1/125	800 - 3200
Action / Sports	f/4 – f/8	1/1000+	400 - 800
Video (Day - 25fps)	f/4 – f/11	1/50	100 - 400
Landscape	f/8 – f/16	1/30 – 1/500	100 - 400

🔗 Official Resources & Creator Channels

Reference Guide & Source Material:

<https://dawidmillenium-design.github.io/VideoCameraHoliday>

YouTube Video Channel:

<https://www.youtube.com/@airqualityinelevator>

Safe travels — and happy filming!

"Pack your camera gear the night before, not the morning of. You'll notice things you forgot, and you'll have peace of mind."